anticlockwise

The direction opposite to that in which the hands of a clock travel.

Example



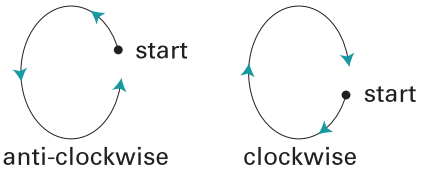
9.30

This clock is fifteen minutes fast. The hands must be moved back to show the exact time.



9.15

The hands have been moved in an anticlockwise direction.



Example

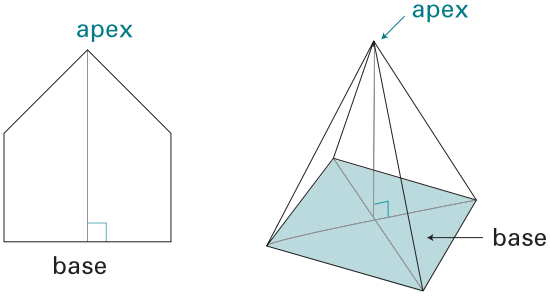
Screws and bottle tops are loosened in an anticlockwise direction.

See clockwise

apex

The highest point where two or more lines meet to form a corner of a figure or solid. The apex is the furthest vertical distance from the base.

Examples



See base, pyramid, vertex

approximately

(symbols: ≈ ≒ ≃)

Nearly, not exactly, but almost. The symbols ≈ or ≒ or ≃ may be used for 'is approximately equal to'.

Example

The expressions

$0.97 \approx 1 \quad 0.97 \fallingdotseq 1 \quad 0.97 \simeq 1$

all mean '0.97 is approximately equal to 1'.

See accurate, rounding

approximation

(symbols: ≈ ≒ ≏)

A result which is nearly, not exactly, but almost accurate. One method of approximation is calculating with rounded figures.

Examples

(i) $798 \times 2.1 \approx 800 \times 2 \approx 1600$

(ii) The value of 3.14 for π is only an approximation.

See accurate, approximately, rounding

Arabic numerals

1, 2, 3, 4, 5 … Now in common use in all western countries.

See Hindu–Arabic